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Michel de Graaf

CTO / Tech lead

I design and build complete systems from the ground up, frontend through infrastructure, and lead the teams that ship them. Mostly fintech startups, where I build financial information systems; sometimes enterprises like IKEA, ING and Tele2.

#typescript #ruby #rust #elixir #lua

Experience

2026 - Current, Peliqan - Chief Technology Officer
Building the Peliqan platform. Investors see their whole portfolio and can act on it: sell a position, finance a commitment, plan ahead. Institutions have had that for decades; everyone else hasn't.

2004 - Current, Re-invention (Founder)
My consultancy company: specialized in advanced (web-based) software solutions.

2024 - Current, Revive Capital B.V - Tech lead (Freelance)
Leading engineering at Revive Capital, a fintech leasing startup. Built their asset-backed lending platform for brokers from scratch.

TypeScript, Rust, TDD, OpenAPI, OpenAI, Basikon, Salesforce, Apex, textract, OCR, Docker, Serverless, Terraform, CI/CD, GITOPS

2023 - 2024, Financial Lease - Tech lead (Freelance)
Built a dealer portal for car leases. A dealer takes a customer's request, finalises the lease and hands over the car in the time it takes to drink two coffees.

TypeScript, GraphQL, tRPC, MUI, React, AWS, Node.js, Next.js, Serverless, Terraform, CI/CD, Salesforce/Apex

2022 - 2023, IKEA - Tech lead | Product owner
Led the IKEA Content Coworker Experience program: getting shop-floor coworkers the information they need, personalised per person, on top of a knowledge graph.

Neo4J, TypeScript, GraphQL, Apollo, React, Azure, Node.js, CI/CD

2022 - 2025, hypotheekrente.nl - Tech lead (Freelance)
Built the lead system that matches people looking for mortgage advice with an advisor who can take them on.

Ruby on Rails, TypeScript, Apollo, GraphQL, Docker, CI/CD, GITOPS, K8S

2019 - 2022, ING / Homigo - CTO (Freelance)
At Homigo, a corporate startup backed by ING Neo, I led the technical implementation of a SaaS productivity platform (mobile/web) for contractors and homeowners to manage home renovations. I designed and implemented the hard parts: real-time chat, file sharing, resource planning, and other domain-specific tools.

Ruby on Rails, TypeScript, React Native, Apollo, GraphQL, Docker, CI/CD

2016 - 2019, BEEQUIP - Tech lead (Freelance)
Developing BEEQUIP's (startup, fintech) online leasing platform from the ground up and helping build the technology team. Designed and implemented BEEHIVE, an information system that captured and automated core business processes, exposing a GraphQL API consumed by the dealer portal and customer portal (BEEPORT). In 2022, BEEQUIP provided €735 million in lease financing, and in 2024, the company was acquired by Apollo Global Management.

Ruby on Rails, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React, Apollo, Salesforce, Dynamics NAV, GraphQL, Docker, AWS, CI/CD

2015 - 2018, Backpackapp - CTO
Building a travel agency platform for backpackers on the go, tackling challenges such as automated document classification and recognition, and developing an offline-first, cross-platform mobile app.

Elixir, React Native, JavaScript

2015 - 2016, Tele2 - Software engineer (Freelance)
Maintaining a software system for commissioning and provisioning 4G network devices. Developed a consistency-checking tool to audit device configurations and enhanced overall software quality by improving tests and engineering practices.

Ruby on Rails, EventMachine, RabbitMQ, Backbone.js, MongoDB, Redis, JavaScript, Docker

2014 - 2016, Postinitial - CTO
Building an e-learning platform for Corporate Finance.

Ruby, JavaScript, Rails, React, Flux, Docker

2008 - 2015, Kabisa - Software engineer / Lead / DevOps / Consultant
Kabisa builds enterprise software in Ruby on Rails and Java. I joined at the start and worked as scrum master, DevOps engineer, lead developer, consultant and architect for clients including Philips, Media Groep Limburg, Seacon Logistics and Yellowbrick.

2007 - 2008, Philips - Internship
Internship where I developed an internet-connected television prototype where users can share photos and play games over the internet.

Education

2008 - 2009, University of Amsterdam - Master Software Engineering
For my master's thesis, I researched Intelligent fuzzing of web applications.

2005 - 2008, Avans Hogeschool 's-Hertogenbosch - Bachelor Computer Science

- Graduated cum laude
- Graduation internship at the Philips Innovation Lab worked on the European-funded Amigo project

Languages

Dutch (mother tongue) • English (fluent) • German (basic)

Honors & Awards & Certificates

- Graduated cum laude for bachelor degree computer science
- Professional Scrum Master certificate (Scrum.org)
- Coursera: Neural Networks and Deep Learning
- Placed first at the RubyenRails 2009 rumble
- Dutch Drivers license (B)